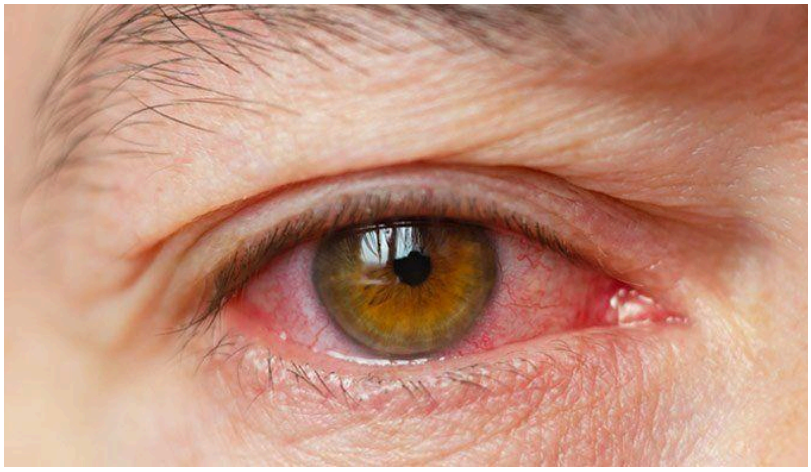
EYE DISEASES

PATHOLOGIES:

- ➔ **Dry eye disease:**
  Dry eye is a condition where your eyes don't produce enough tears or the right kind of tears to keep your eyes moist. It can happen because of age, environmental factors, or certain medications.

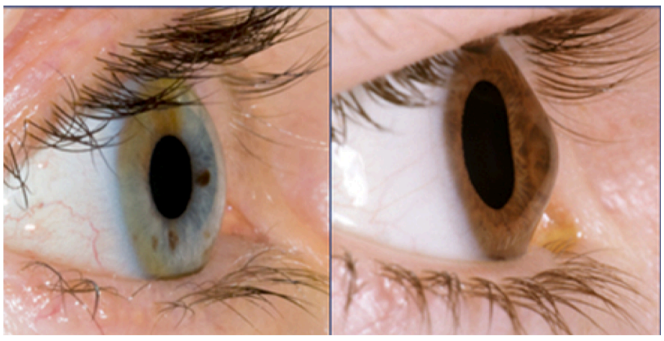


Common Symptoms:

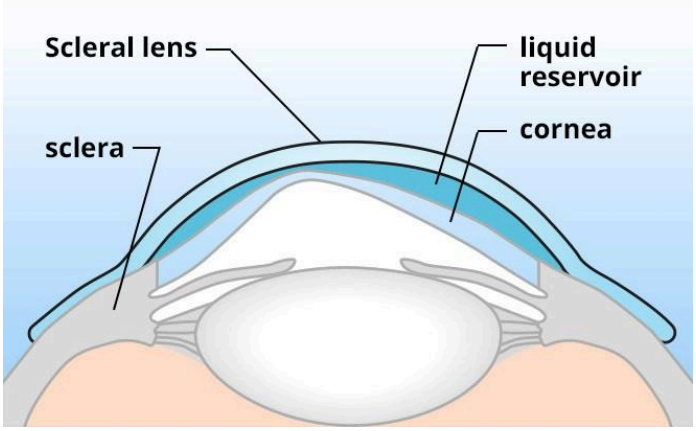
- A feeling of dryness or grittiness in the eyes
- Red, irritated, or itchy eyes
- Watery eyes (due to irritation)
- Blurry vision that improves with blinking
- Sensitivity to wind or smoke

If you experience these symptoms, it's important to see an eye care professional. Dry eye can often be managed with eye drops, lifestyle changes, or other treatments to help keep your eyes comfortable.

- ➔ **Keratoconus:**
  Keratoconus is a condition where the cornea (the clear front surface of the eye) becomes thin and starts to bulge outwards into a cone shape. This can cause your vision to become blurry or distorted. It usually starts in your teenage years and can affect both eyes.



- Normal cornea Keratoconus



Common Symptoms:

- Blurry or distorted vision
- Increased sensitivity to light and glare
- Difficulty seeing clearly at night
- Frequent changes in prescription glasses or contact lenses
- Double vision in one eye

If you experience any of these symptoms, it's important to visit an eye care professional for proper diagnosis and treatment. In some cases, keratoconus can be managed with special contact lenses or surgery.

➔ **Cataract:**
A cataract is a clouding of the lens inside your eye, which can make your vision blurry or dim. It's like looking through a foggy window. Cataracts develop slowly and can affect one or both eyes.

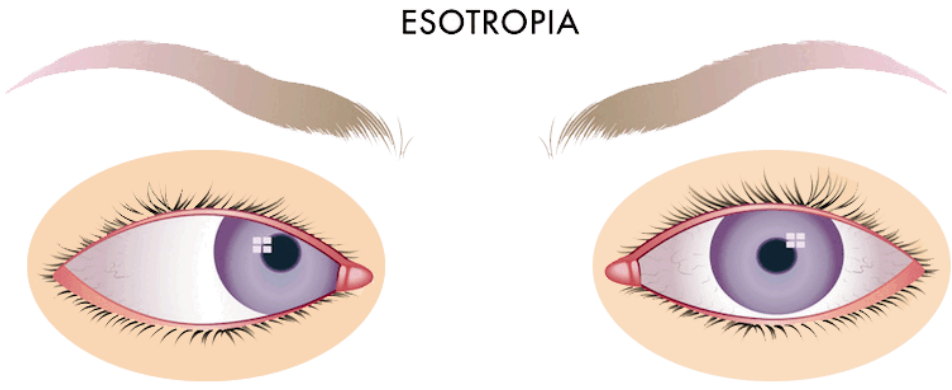
➔ 

Common Symptoms:

- Blurry or cloudy vision
- Difficulty seeing at night or in low light
- Sensitivity to bright lights or glare
- Fading or yellowing of colors
- Double vision in one eye

If you notice any of these symptoms, it's important to see an eye care professional. Cataracts can often be treated with surgery to restore clear vision.

➔ **Squint (misalignment of eyes):**
Squint, also known as strabismus, is a condition where the eyes are not aligned properly and point in different directions. One eye may turn inward, outward, upward, or downward, while the other eye focuses straight ahead. This can affect vision and depth perception.



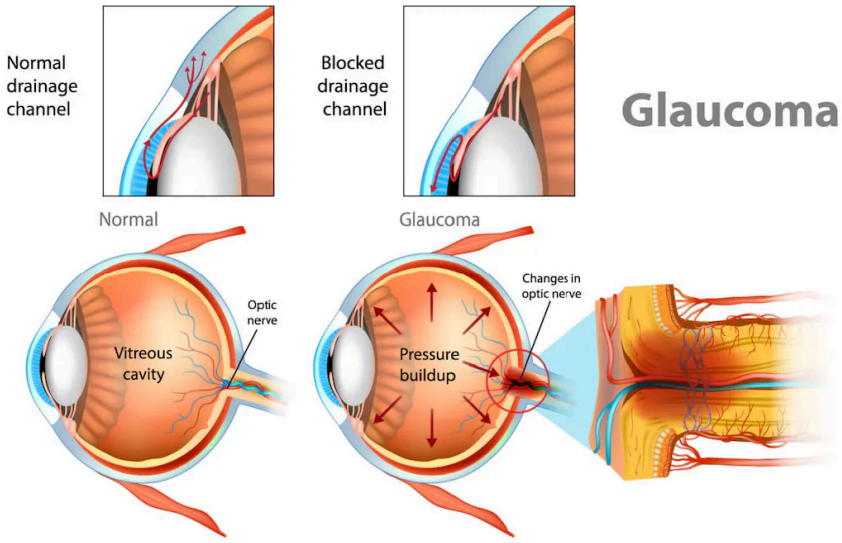
Common Symptoms:

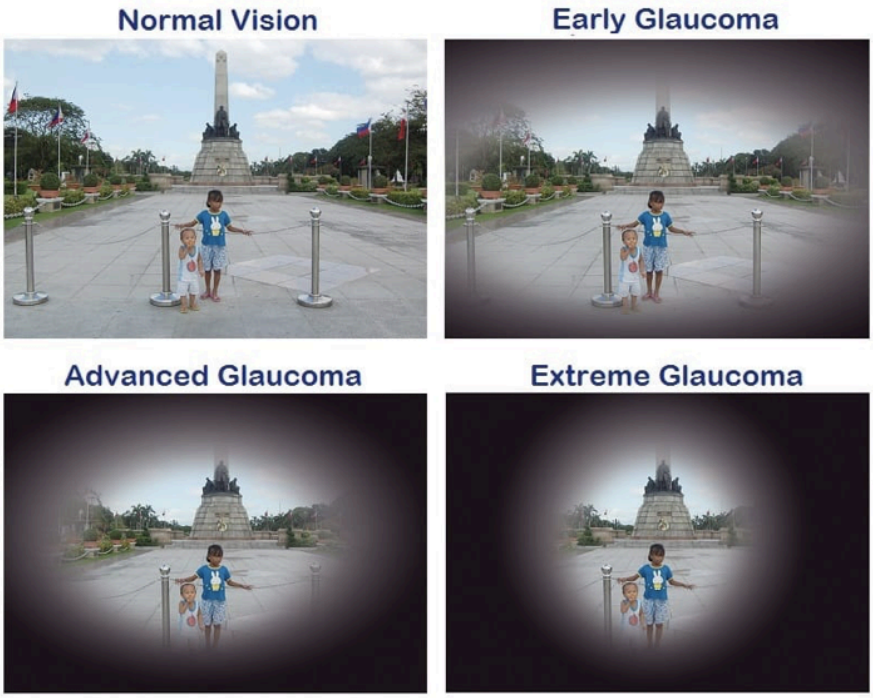
- Eyes that don’t look in the same direction
- Double vision
- Difficulty with depth perception (judging distances)
- One eye may appear to drift or turn
- Frequent tilting of the head to focus

Squint can develop in children or adults and can sometimes be treated with glasses, eye exercises, or surgery to realign the eyes. Early detection and treatment are important to prevent long-term vision problems.

➔ **Glaucoma:**

Glaucoma is a condition that damages the optic nerve in your eye, usually due to high eye pressure. This can lead to complete vision loss if not treated. It often develops slowly, and you might not notice any changes in your vision until it's more advanced.





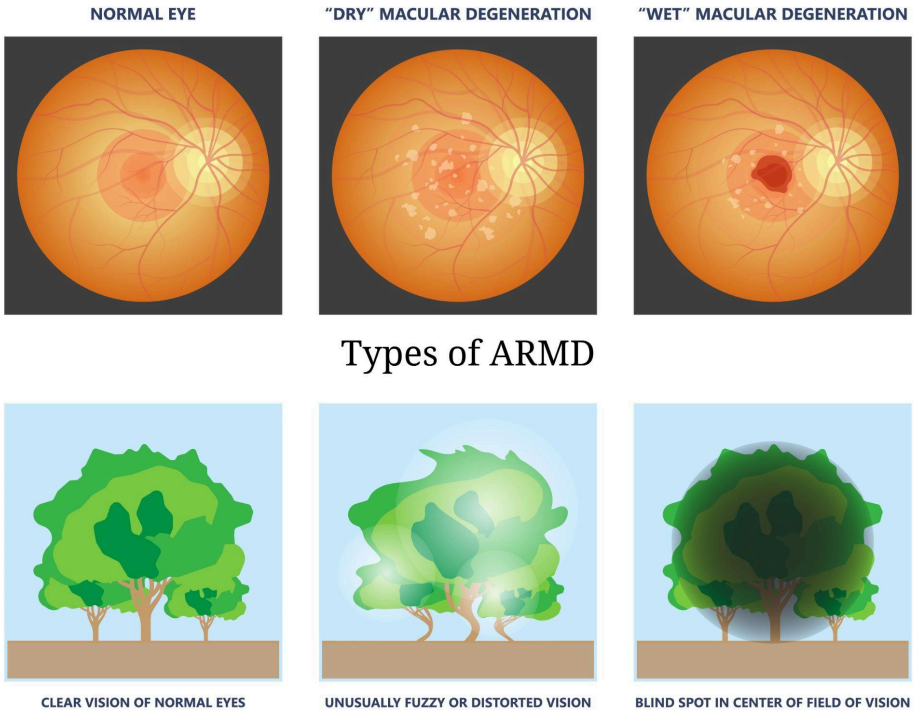
Common Symptoms:

- In the early stages, there may be no symptoms.
- Gradual loss of peripheral (side) vision
- Blurry or hazy vision
- Eye pain, headache, or nausea (in some cases)
- Seeing rainbow-colored rings around lights

If you notice any of these symptoms, it's important to see an eye care professional as soon as possible. Glaucoma can be controlled with medication, laser treatment, or surgery, but early detection is key to preventing further damage.

➔ **ARMD:**

Age-Related Macular Degeneration (ARMD) is a condition that affects the macula, the part of the eye responsible for sharp, central vision. It commonly occurs in people over 50 and can make it difficult to see fine details, like reading or recognizing faces.

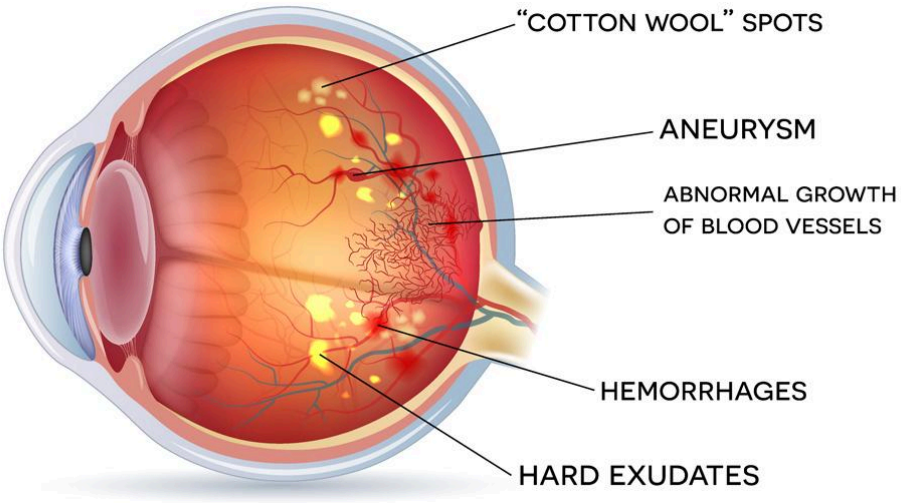


Common Symptoms:

- Blurry or dimmed central vision
- Difficulty seeing fine details, especially when reading or driving
- Distorted vision (straight lines may appear wavy)
- Dark or empty spots in the center of your vision
- Reduced color perception

If you experience any of these symptoms, it's important to see an eye care professional. While ARMD can't be cured, treatments can help slow its progression and manage symptoms, especially if detected early.

➔ **Diabetic retinopathy:**
Diabetic retinopathy is a condition that affects the blood vessels in the retina (the back part of your eye) due to high blood sugar levels from diabetes. Over time, these blood vessels can leak, swell, or become blocked, which can harm your vision.

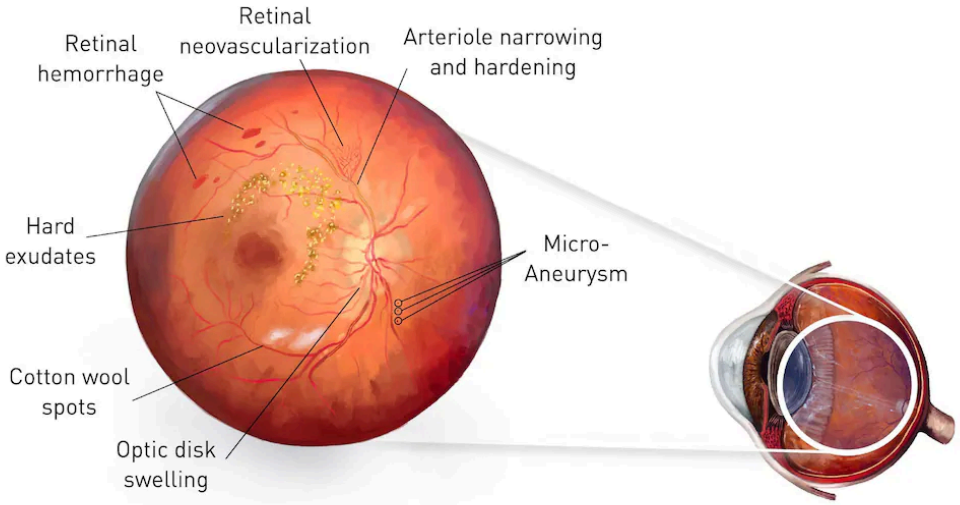


Common Symptoms:

- Blurry or fluctuating vision
- Dark spots or floaters in your vision
- Difficulty seeing at night
- In severe cases, sudden vision loss

If you have diabetes and notice any of these symptoms, it's important to visit an eye care professional regularly. Early detection and treatment can help prevent serious vision problems. Managing your blood sugar levels and having regular eye exams are key in preventing diabetic retinopathy.

➔ **Hypertensive retinopathy:**
Hypertensive retinopathy is a condition where high blood pressure damages the blood vessels in the retina, the part of the eye that helps you see. Over time, uncontrolled high blood pressure can lead to changes in the eye’s blood vessels, affecting your vision.



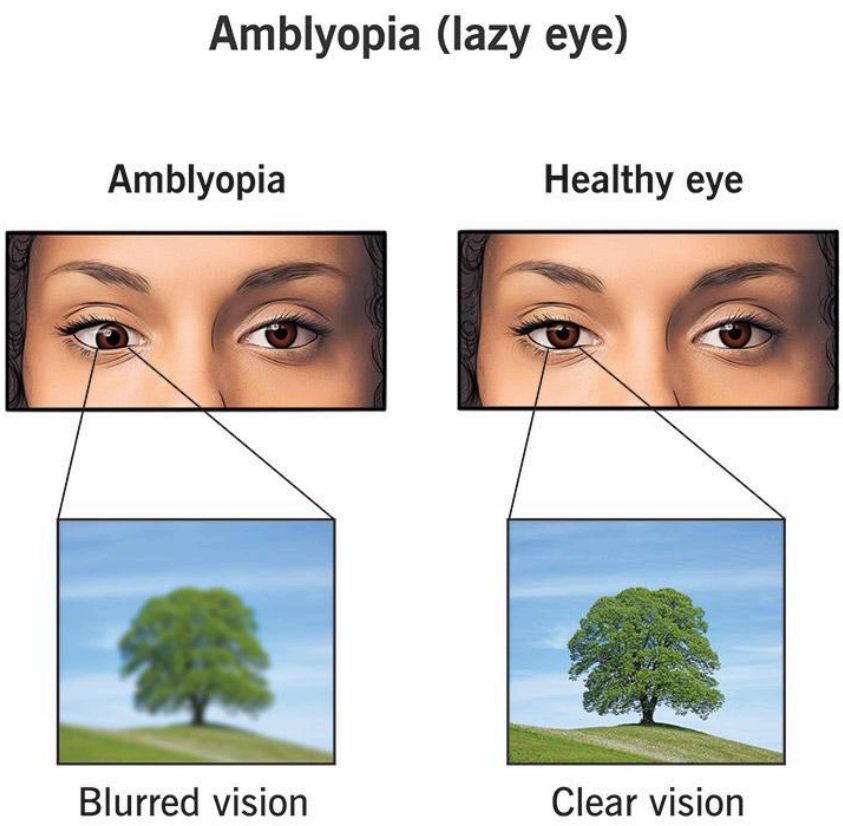
Common Symptoms:

- Blurry or hazy vision
- Seeing spots or floaters
- Sudden vision loss (in severe cases)
- Difficulty seeing clearly in bright or low light

Often, there are no early symptoms, so it's important to have regular eye exams if you have high blood pressure. Treating and controlling your blood pressure can help prevent or slow the progression of hypertensive retinopathy and protect your vision.

DISORDERS:

➔ **Amblyopia:**
Amblyopia, also known as "lazy eye," is a condition where one eye does not develop normal vision, often because the brain favors the other eye. It usually begins in childhood and can be caused by conditions like crossed eyes (strabismus), a large difference in vision between the two eyes, or a blockage in the eye, such as a cataract.

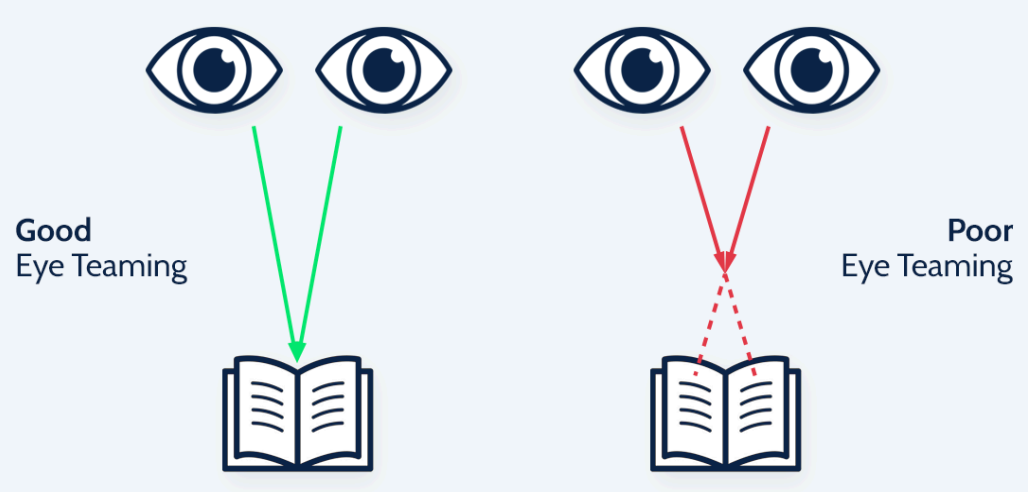


Common symptoms:

- Squinting or tilting the head to see better
- Difficulty seeing clearly with one eye
- Eyes that appear to be misaligned (crossed or wandering)
- Poor depth perception
- Vision problems that don’t improve with glasses or contact lenses

Treatment is most effective when started early and can include wearing glasses, patching the stronger eye to strengthen the weaker one and most effectively by vision therapy, in some cases surgery. If you notice any of these signs, it's important to have an eye exam by an eye care professional to catch and treat amblyopia as early as possible.

➔ **Vergence abnormalities:**
Vergence abnormalities occur when the eyes have difficulty working together to focus on objects at different distances. This can lead to problems with depth perception, eye strain, and blurry vision, especially when reading or focusing on something close up for a long time.





Common Symptoms:

- Eye strain or fatigue, especially when reading or using a computer
- Blurry or double vision
- Headaches
- Difficulty focusing on nearby objects
- Frequent need to squint or close one eye to see better

Vergence issues can often be treated with eye exercises, corrective lenses, or other vision therapy. If you experience these symptoms, it’s important to see an eye care professional who can help diagnose and treat the condition to improve your vision and comfort.

➔ **Accommodative abnormalities:**
Accommodative abnormalities occur when your eyes have trouble focusing on objects at different distances, especially when switching between looking at something far away and something up close. This can be due to a problem with the eye's focusing ability, often related to age or certain health conditions.



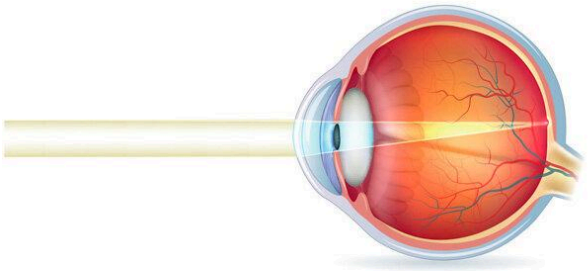
Common Symptoms:

- Blurry vision when reading or doing close-up work
- Difficulty switching focus between near and distant objects
- Eye strain or fatigue, especially after reading for a while
- Headaches after reading or working on a computer
- Frequent need to squint to see clearly

Accommodative problems can be treated with corrective glasses, eye exercises, or other therapies. If you experience these symptoms, seeing eye care professional is important for proper diagnosis and treatment.

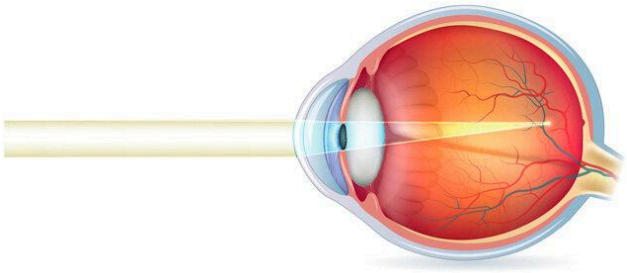
➔ **Myopia & its management**

Myopia, also known as nearsightedness, is a condition where you can see objects up close clearly, but distant objects appear blurry. This happens when the eyeball is too long or the cornea is too curved, causing light to focus in front of the retina instead of directly on it.



NORMAL VISION

FARAWAY OBJECT IS CLEAR

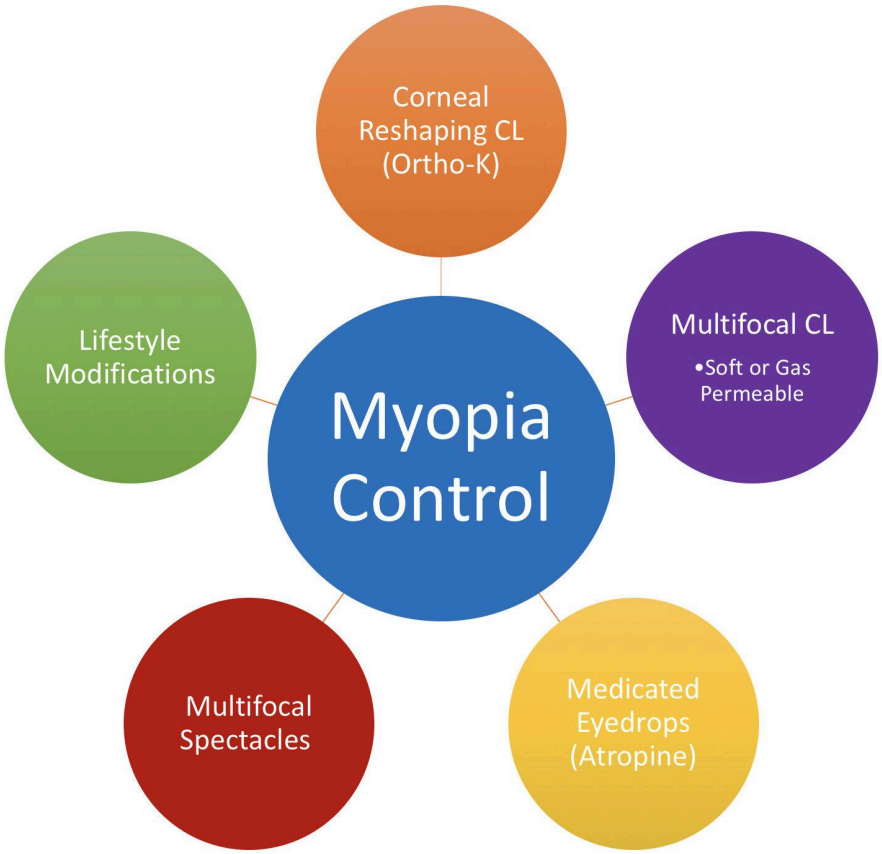


MYOPIA

NEARSIGHTED EYE

THE EYEBALL IS TOO LONG

FARAWAY OBJECT IS BLURRY



Common Symptoms:

- Blurry vision for distant objects (e.g., road signs, movies)
- Squinting to see clearly
- Eye strain, especially after reading or using screens for long periods
- Frequent headaches

Special Management for Myopia:

1. Eyeglasses or Contact Lenses: These are the most common treatments, helping to focus light properly on the retina and improving distant vision.

2. Orthokeratology (Ortho-K): Special contact lenses are worn overnight to reshape the cornea temporarily, improving vision during the day without the need for glasses or contacts.

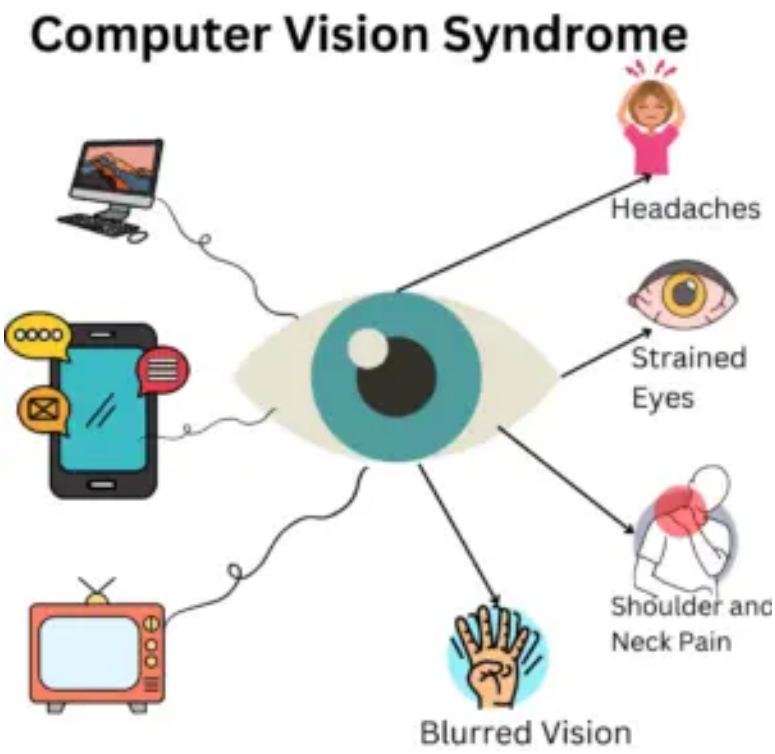
3. Refractive Surgery (LASIK or PRK): These surgical procedures reshape the cornea permanently to correct myopia and reduce or eliminate the need for glasses or contact lenses.

4. Atropine Eye Drops: Low-dose atropine drops can sometimes be prescribed to slow the progression of myopia, particularly in children.

5. Myopia Control Lenses: Special types of glasses or contact lenses are designed to slow myopia progression, particularly in children, by reducing the strain on the eyes.

If you experience any of these symptoms, it's important to see an eye care professional. Proper management can help improve vision and, in some cases, slow the progression of myopia.

➔ **Computer vision syndrome:**
Computer Vision Syndrome (CVS) is a condition caused by spending long hours in front of a computer, smartphone, or other digital screens. It can lead to eye strain and discomfort due to focusing on the screen for extended periods without proper breaks or adjustments.



Common Symptoms:

- Eye strain or fatigue
- Dry or itchy eyes
- Blurry or double vision
- Headaches, especially after long screen time
- Difficulty focusing on nearby objects
- Neck, shoulder, or back pain from poor posture

Management:

Take Frequent Breaks: Follow the 20-20-20 rule: every 20 minutes, take a 20-second break and look at something 20 feet away.

Adjust Screen Settings: Increase text size, reduce screen brightness, and ensure proper contrast for comfort.

Proper Lighting: Reduce glare on screens by using ambient lighting and adjusting your workspace.

Use Computer Glasses: Special glasses designed to reduce eye strain when working with digital devices.

Maintain Good Posture: Sit with your back straight, shoulders relaxed, and your screen at eye level.

If you're experiencing symptoms of CVS, consulting an eye care professional can help identify solutions and improve your comfort during screen use.

➔ **Color Blindness:**

Color blindness, also known as color vision deficiency, is a condition where you have difficulty distinguishing between certain colors. It is most often inherited and affects more men than women. While the condition doesn't cause complete blindness, it can make it challenging to identify specific colors.



Common Symptoms:

- Difficulty distinguishing between red and green or blue and yellow.
- Trouble seeing the difference between certain shades of the same color.
- Colors may appear dull or washed out.

Management:

There are no cures for color blindness, but certain aids like special glasses and contact lenses or color-identifying apps can help.
If you suspect you have color blindness or are having trouble distinguishing colors, talk to an eye care professional for testing and support.